



Alex Karp
Co-Founder & CEO

\$4.48B (FY2025)
Revenue

Denver
HQ

01 Who You're Meeting

Alex Karp — Co-Founder & CEO, Palantir Technologies.

In role: Co-founded Palantir in 2003–2004; CEO since 2005; board member since 2003

Today: Leads Palantir's strategy and is its principal public voice, having personally driven the AIP Bootcamp go-to-market motion that pulled US commercial revenue up sharply.

A philosopher and lawyer by training rather than a technologist, which is unusual for a software CEO and shapes how he argues. He holds a BA from Haverford College, a JD from Stanford University, and a PhD from Goethe University in Frankfurt, where his work was in social theory. Before Palantir he worked in investing and money management, founding the London-based Caedmon Group. He co-founded Palantir with Peter Thiel, Stephen Cohen and Joe Lonsdale, and it was seeded in part by In-Q-Tel, the CIA's venture arm — the origin of its government-first strategy.

Career: Chief Executive Officer, Palantir Technologies; Co-Founder and Director, Palantir Technologies; Founder; investing and money management, Caedmon Group (London)

Education: PhD, Goethe University Frankfurt; JD, Stanford University; BA, Haverford College

The company: The best-capitalized, fastest-growing name in this market by far — GAAP-profitable, ~56% revenue growth, and a fast-scaling "AIP Bootcamp" go-to-market motion pulling U.S. commercial revenue up over 130% YoY.

What they sell: Four core platforms: Gotham (defense/intelligence), Foundry (commercial enterprise data integration), Apollo (deployment infrastructure) and AIP (AI Platform, launched 2023) — lets organizations deploy LLMs directly against their own operational data.

02 Where The Company Sits

Broadest platform ambition and by far the largest balance sheet in this market. Closest comparable to Sand on category ambition ("operating system" framing) but built for data/decisions generally, not physical-infrastructure control specifically.

03 Talking Points

- Trained in philosophy and law, not engineering — he argues from first principles about institutions and will engage on why before how.
- The AIP Bootcamp motion is the fastest way to test Palantir on a real PortCo problem without a long procurement cycle.
- Founder voting control means commercial flexibility exists if he wants it to. Escalation is unusually meaningful here.

What to pressure-test about the company:

- Valuation is priced for perfection — among the most expensive large-cap software multiples in the market
- Deep ties to defense/intelligence work draw recurring criticism (ACLU and others) over predictive-policing use of Gotham
- Customer lock-in risk is real: once operations run on Foundry's ontology, switching costs are very high

04 GIP Context

GIP: No named GIP portfolio company was confirmed as a Palantir customer in available sources. The sectoral overlap is real — Palantir markets Foundry/AIP explicitly for "critical infrastructure," construction (named partners McCarthy and Kiewit), and government, territory that includes GIP-style assets like airports, ports and utilities

BlackRock: Confirmed and substantial, but passive: BlackRock is one of Palantir's largest institutional shareholders, holding roughly 5.5%–8.7% of shares outstanding across recent 13G/13F filings (an ~\$19.9B position as of mid-2026, per TIKR/SEC...)

Others at Palantir Technologies: Stephen Cohen (Co-Founder & President); Peter Thiel (Co-Founder & Chairman of the Board); Shyam Sankar (Chief Technology Officer)

www.palantir.com · [Palantir investor management page](#) · [SEC registration statement \(biographies\)](#) · [Company LinkedIn](#)

Public professional and company information from the research layer of the GIP vendor tracker, generated September 15, 2026. Figures are as reported by the sources listed on the vendor's white page and are not independently audited. Research goes stale — re-run before external use.